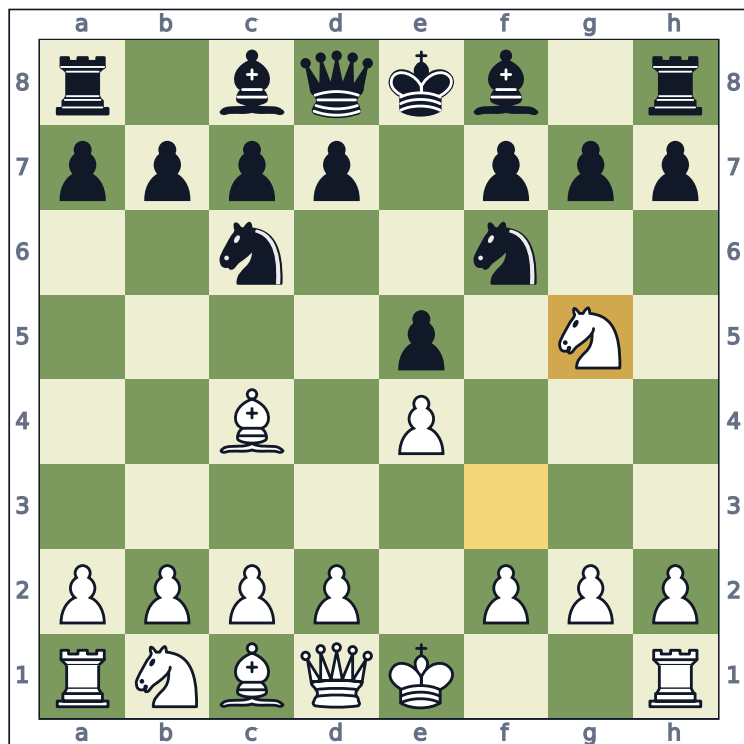


ITALIAN GAME, RUY LOPEZ, AND RELATED OPEN GAMES

Italian Game

ECO C57 | 17 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.04 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Active and tactical: both sides must calculate forcing moves before following a thematic plan.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

C57 covers Italian Game. White develops with pressure on e5 while Black builds a secure center and seeks the freeing ...d5 break. The diagram uses the featured line Italian Game: Two Knights Defense, Knight Attack.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. Ng5

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Castle, prepare d4, improve the least active piece, and preserve pressure rather than forcing tactics that are not ready.

BLACK'S GOALS

Defend e5 efficiently, challenge the center with ...d5, and use queenside or kingside activity according to White's structure.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

d4 and ...d5 define most transformations. c3 often supports d4; ...c5 may challenge a closed center.

PIECE MAP

The bishops on c4/b5 and c5/b4 shape development. Rooks become active on e- and d-files after central exchanges. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

The position can look quiet while tactical pressure accumulates on e5, f7, and along central files. The word 'attack' is a name, not a guarantee; complete development before forcing matters.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

Black moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on e4, Black pawn on e5.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

Elite, fully sound opening territory. It rewards patient improvement as much as concrete calculation.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C57 line

This section preserves all 17 names and defining routes assigned to C57 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Italian Game: Two Knights Defense, Fegatello Attack, Leonhardt Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. Ng5 d5 5. exd5 Nxd5 6. Nxf7 Kxf7 7. Qf3+ Ke6 8. Nc3 Nb4 9. Qe4 c6 10. a3 Na6 11. d4 Nc7

002 Italian Game: Two Knights Defense, Fried Liver Attack

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. Ng5 d5 5. exd5 Nxd5 6. Nxf7

003 Italian Game: Two Knights Defense, Fritz Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. Ng5 d5 5. exd5 Nd4

004 Italian Game: Two Knights Defense, Fritz, Gruber Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. Ng5 d5 5. exd5 Nd4 6. c3 b5 7. Bf1 Nxd5 8. Ne4

005 Italian Game: Two Knights Defense, Kloss Gambit

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. Ng5 d5 5. exd5 Nb4

006 Italian Game: Two Knights Defense, Knight Attack

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. Ng5

007 Italian Game: Two Knights Defense, Knight Attack, Normal Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. Ng5 d5

008 Italian Game: Two Knights Defense, Lolli Attack

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. Ng5 d5 5. exd5 Nxd5 6. d4

009 Italian Game: Two Knights Defense, Pincus Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. Ng5 d5 5. exd5 Nxd5 6. d4 Bb4+

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C57 line

This section preserves all 17 names and defining routes assigned to C57 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

010 Italian Game: Two Knights Defense, Ponziani-Steinitz Gambit

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. Ng5 Nxe4

011 Italian Game: Two Knights Defense, Traxler Counterattack

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. Ng5 Bc5

012 Italian Game: Two Knights Defense, Traxler Counterattack, Bishop Sacrifice Line

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. Ng5 Bc5 5. Bxf7+

013 Italian Game: Two Knights Defense, Traxler Counterattack, King March Line

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. Ng5 Bc5 5. Nxf7 Bxf2+ 6. Kxf2 Nxe4+ 7. Ke3

014 Italian Game: Two Knights Defense, Traxler Counterattack, Knight Sacrifice Line

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. Ng5 Bc5 5. Nxf7

015 Italian Game: Two Knights Defense, Traxler Variation, Trencianske-Teplice Gambit

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. Ng5 Bc5 5. Bxf7+ Ke7 6. d4

016 Italian Game: Two Knights Defense, Ulvestad Variation

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. Ng5 d5 5. exd5 b5

017 Italian Game: Two Knights Defense, Ulvestad Variation, Kurkin Gambit

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bc4 Nf6 4. Ng5 d5 5. exd5 b5 6. Bf1 h6 7. Nxf7